

Chapter 8 Test— Answer Key

Matching [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Match each item to the correct answer.

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| <u>E</u> 1. Knowledge | A. The belief that truth, knowledge, and morality are relative to the individual, society, or historical context |
| <u>F</u> 2. Objective truth claim | B. The willingness to recognize and respect the dignity of those with whom one disagrees |
| <u>D</u> 3. Subjective truth claim | C. A movement promoting confidence in rationalism and science, as well as skepticism of supernatural and religious authorities |
| <u>G</u> 4. Plausibility structure | D. A claim regarding a dependent fact about the subject |
| <u>C</u> 5. Modernism | E. Justified true belief |
| <u>H</u> 6. Postmodernism | F. A claim regarding an independent fact about the world |
| <u>A</u> 7. Relativism | G. A view of the world that determines what is reasonable or possible |
| <u>B</u> 8. Tolerance | H. A worldview that teaches there is no defining source for truth and reality |

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

9. In John 18:37, what did Jesus say was his purpose in coming to the world?
 - a. to reign as king of the Jews
 - b. to bear witness to the truth**
 - c. to preach the good news of the kingdom of God
 - d. to glorify the Father
 - e. to bring to light things hidden in darkness
10. In John 14:6, what did Jesus claim to be?
 - a. the Life**
 - b. the Way**
 - c. the Door
 - d. the Truth**
 - e. the Light
11. What command(s) are given in Luke 6:35–36?
 - a. Be merciful.**
 - b. Expect nothing in return when you do good or lend to others.**
 - c. Love your enemies.**
 - d. Judge not.
 - e. Listen to my voice.

12. What does John 16:13 teach that the Holy Spirit will do?
 - a. He will intercede for Jesus' followers according to the will of God.
 - b. He will guide Jesus' followers into all the truth.**
 - c. He will distribute gifts to Jesus' followers individually as he wills.
 - d. He will declare the things that are to come.**
 - e. He will seal Jesus' followers for the day of redemption.
13. What do Christians believe about truth?
 - a. that it is possible to know truth**
 - b. that God made us able to discover truth**
 - c. that truth cannot ultimately be known
 - d. that knowing what is true brings freedom**
 - e. that it is only possible to find truth outside religion
14. How do human beings discover truth?
 - a. by using their five senses**
 - b. through reason**
 - c. through experience**
 - d. through the scientific method**
 - e. through revelation**
15. What four tests can be used to test the truth of a specific claim?
 - a. the tests of reason, the outer world, the inner world, and the real world**
 - b. the tests of clarity, coherence, consistency, and conciseness
 - c. the tests of the outer world, the inner world, the real world, and the surreal world
 - d. the tests of reason, risk, the inner world, and the real world
 - e. the tests of objectivity, subjectivity, correspondence, and plausibility
16. What led to the Enlightenment?
 - a. Protestants reformers who questioned Catholics' theological authority**
 - b. nation-states that asserted their independence from the Catholic church**
 - c. wars and violence that led to disillusionment with religious and political authorities**
 - d. postmodernism and its skepticism of metanarratives
 - e. Nietzsche's "The Parable of the Madman"
17. What does modernism teach?
 - a. Reality is just a matter of perspective.
 - b. We can gain greater understanding of the world through science.**
 - c. What is true and moral is entirely up to the individual.
 - d. Science and technological advances make human progress inevitable.**
 - e. People who claim to have the truth are trying to gain power or privilege.

18. What are the basic ideas of postmodernism?
- a. Religion is not a matter of personal taste but an objective truth to which we submit.
 - b. Science can tell us our purpose and how we should live.
 - c. No truth or metanarrative can make sense of all reality.**
 - d. Truth is not discoverable; each person constructs the truth as he or she sees fit.**
 - e. What cannot be proven by reason is untrue.
19. What does relativism teach?
- a. Human reason is the surest source for discovering absolute truth.
 - b. Our knowledge of the world cannot be objectively true.
 - c. In looking to others for truth, you surrender your own identity and authority.**
 - d. Each and every culture's understanding of truth is valid and acceptable.**
 - e. The world can be completely explained through cause and effect.
20. What does the classic view of tolerance require?
- a. agreeing with other's religious beliefs or morals
 - b. considering people who try to persuade anyone else intolerant
 - c. living peacefully with others in a diverse society**
 - d. allowing others to express their ideas without fear of abuse or reprisal**
 - e. avoiding judgment of any kind

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

T 21. In John 14:6, Jesus said, “No one comes to the Father except through me.”

F 22. The lower story is God's universal revelation about himself and morality from nature and conscience. general revelation

F 23. The upper story is God's unique revelation about himself through Jesus Christ, the Holy Spirit, the Scriptures, and miraculous events special revelation

T 24. The correspondence theory of truth teaches that for beliefs to be true, they must correspond to the way the world actually is. _____

F 25. A belief or idea that someone holds about the nature of reality is, in itself, sufficient for determining truth. insufficient

T 26. An objective truth claim is not always true. _____

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Question 29 is worth 4 points.]

Fill in the missing word(s) to complete each statement.

27. All true knowing involves risk because human beings are not God and our knowledge is always limited.
28. Treating scientific discoveries as the only objective truths, while relegating religion to the realm of personal preference, arbitrarily limits the scope of knowledge.
29. If relativism is true, no one has the right to say that another person's actions or cultural practice is wrong even if it involves harming someone else.
30. Tolerance is a virtue, but Christians are commanded to do more than simply tolerate others. Jesus commands his followers to love others.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

31. Explain who René Descartes was, what he said, why he said it, and the impact it had.
René Descartes was a French mathematician and philosopher. He said, "I think, therefore I am." He said this because he thought human reason provided a secure foundation on which people could base all other beliefs. His ideas led later philosophers to reject divine revelation. His ideas also eventually led to modernism.
32. In what way is postmodernism self-refuting?
Postmodernism is self-refuting because it says no metanarratives can be trusted except for the postmodern metanarrative that no trustworthy metanarratives exist.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

33. Pilate asked "What is truth?" Answer his question by describing the Christian view of truth.
Possible answer: Christians believe that truth exists and can be known. God created the universe and human beings in such a way that we can use our faculties to understand the world around us. God reveals truth about himself and morality through nature and our conscience; this is known as general revelation. He also provided special revelation to teach us more about himself and his will for our lives. Special revelation comes through Jesus Christ, the Holy Spirit, the Bible, and miraculous events. Because human beings are sinful and limited, we can be mistaken about our knowledge. None of us completely understand all truth.

34. Explain how to evaluate objective and subjective truth claims.

Possible answer: An objective truth claim is a claim regarding an independent fact about the world. So, to evaluate an objective truth claim, we can use many different tools, including the tests of reason (Is it reasonable?), the outer world (Is there evidence to support the claim?), the inner world (Does the claim ring true to us, based on what we have experienced?), and the real world (What are the consequences if this claim is true?). A subjective truth claim is a claim regarding a dependent fact about the subject, the person who is making the claim. It is a matter of preference or taste. To evaluate a subjective truth claim, we must focus on the subject. Is it reasonable for that person to make that claim? Is there evidence that the claim is consistent with his or her behavior or previous statements? Is the person known to be truthful?

35. Explain why tolerance matters when you are discussing truth with someone who disagrees with you. **Possible answer:** All people are made in God's image and should be respected. Tolerance matters in discussions of truth when you disagree about something. This means that when we speak with others, we are to be humble. We should not be hypocritical, judgmental, or rude. We should be willing to apply the same standards to our own truth claims that we apply to others' truth claims. Jesus taught that we should love even our enemies. Therefore, we demonstrate a tolerant and loving spirit with them.